Braden Kinnes

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Education

Colorado Mesa University – Grand Junction, CO
Bachelor of Science, Mechanical Engineering Technology — Expected Spring 2027
GPA: 3.02 (provosts list Fall of '25 and Spring of '25)

Projects

ENGR 495 – Independent Study – S.C.O.R.E. (Jan–May 2026)

- Co-led team in designing a compact and waterproof device that promotes cleanliness and competition in the bathroom
- Won first place during the CMU student showcase
- Performed materials science research relating to waterproofing and chemical reactions with urine and other harmful chemicals
- Learned packaging engineering techniques to fit circuits and hardware inside a confined container

ENGR 345 – Integration I – Sand Plotter Table (Aug-Dec 2025)

- Designed and built a 2-axis sand plotter table using stepper motors and Arduino based controls
- Developed and troubleshot code for plotter table
- Created a website to document progress (website is linked here: coloradomesa.edu/~bskinnes)

ENGR 385 – Integration II – Rover (Jan–May 2026)

- Designed and built an autonomous rover with RF, object detection, and GPS capabilities
- Developed and troubleshot code for rover
- Developed skills with circuits and microcontrollers

Experience

Server/Host | Outback Steakhouse – Grand Junction, CO (Mar 2024–Present)

- Promoted from host to server; strengthened communication, multitasking, and customer service skills
- Thrived in high-pressure environments requiring teamwork and efficiency
- Consistently near the top of the weekly liquor and dessert sales rankings

Tech III | Powderhorn Ski Resort – Mesa, CO (Nov 2022–Present)

- Developed specialized skills in precision epoxy work for edge replacement and repair
- Developed specialized skills in base grinding and restoring ski structure
- Basic tuning skills including waxing and sharpening edges
- Certified Rossignol and Soloman technician

Activities & Interests

- Varsity Two-Sport Athlete (High School, 2017–2021)
- Volunteer: Young Life Christian Camp (2021); Special Olympics events (2022–2024)
- Clubs: Colorado Mesa Ski and Board Club (2025)
- Outdoor enthusiast: skiing, hiking, fishing